

James Tannahill

AI/ML for Capital Markets, xAI (now part of SpaceXSI)

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James Tannahill builds AI-native financial intelligence at xAI, now part of SpaceXSI, where he owns the financial-reasoning data and evaluation systems used to train frontier models on institutional capital markets.

At xAI, he designs the grading rubrics, adversarial evaluation tasks, and production Python/AWS tooling that teach frontier models how investors actually underwrite, spanning LBO, DCF, credit, and M&A reasoning, bridging the trading desk and the training loop.

Before xAI, he rose from principal to president of Plocamium Holdings, his family's third-generation investment office, which deployed more than $400 million across 30-plus investments in healthcare services, life sciences, industrial technology, and manufacturing. He personally originated, underwrote, and led 11 of those investments end to end, serving as lead investor and board member across the portfolio. Within the platform he co-founded and led 1Ness Strategies, a healthcare marketing and SaaS business built to 80-plus clients and profitability within 18 months, and advised on more than $150 million in capital raises as a board partner at RDLB.

His earlier career spans strategic finance and research. As AVP, Strategic Finance at Vaxart, Inc. (NASDAQ: VXRT), he led more than $100 million in strategic transactions, including a $50 million manufacturing acquisition and $50 million-plus in BARDA and DoD non-dilutive funding. At M Science (Jefferies Group), he delivered alternative-data healthcare research to institutional funds managing $5 billion-plus. At Accrete.AI he built the NLP pipelines that turned unstructured text into investable signal, and he began his career initiating sell-side coverage on 50-plus biotechnology names at H.C. Wainwright & Co.

An engineer as well as an investor, he designs and ships production machine-learning systems end to end: a multi-agent research and entity-intelligence engine on AWS, live systematic trading agents, and a signal-validation harness built to separate genuine edge from overfitting before capital is committed.

EDUCATION

Cornell University, SC Johnson College of Business, MBA
University of Essex, MSc Biotechnology
Denison University, BS Biochemistry

AFFILIATIONS

Young Presidents' Organization (YPO); Economic Club of New York; St. Francis Yacht Club; Cornell Club of New York; Student Sponsor Partners (Mentor). Captained the Denison sailing team; 1,000-plus hours of coastal and open-ocean racing.